

US States Learning Game - Teacher's Guide

This guide supports the use of the two-level HTML5 game designed to help students learn U.S. state-capital pairs and associated geographic features using UDL principles.

How to Use the Game

Level 1 - Match & Memorize:

- Students type a U.S. state name.
- The capital will be revealed if correctly entered.
- Audio feedback is played automatically (TTS).

Level 2 - Explore Geography:

- Students type a state name.
- Capital and a geographic feature are displayed.
- System reads the capital name aloud.
- This level promotes deeper place-based thinking.

Scoring and Progress Tracking (Planned Feature)

- Each correct match counts as +1 point.
- Score displays after each valid answer.
- Future updates will store score via local browser memory (localStorage), allowing progress tracking.

Differentiation Tips

- Use Level 1 for direct instruction, timed review, or flashcard-style drills.
- Use Level 2 for extension, writing prompts, or state projects (What's special about this state?).
- Pair students to challenge each other, increasing peer engagement.

Assessment Ideas

- Pre/Post test using a printable blank map.
- Verbal check-in during the game session (e.g., Why is this state's capital important?).
- Score log sheets to track progress and reinforce memory.

Classroom Integration Ideas

- Launch during Social Studies centers or geography warm-ups.
- Use projector and have students compete in teams.
- Homework: ask students to complete 10 new states and write a fun fact about one.

UDL Alignment Summary

- Multiple Means of Representation – visual map, text, audio.
- Multiple Means of Action/Expression – typing, feedback, self-pacing.
- Multiple Means of Engagement – level choice, feedback, learner agency.